

Standard Chartered

3Q25 first take: good print

Reiterate Rating: UNDERPERFORM | PO: 139.10 HKD | Price: 153.00 HKD

Overall: Good 3Q across all lines

Overall, Standard Chartered printed a good set of Q3 numbers. Underlying PBT was 14% (or \$243m) ahead of consensus, driven by higher income and lower impairments. Within the income line, the beat was from both NII and non-NII, and within non-NII, Wealth and Banking beat expectations while Global Markets missed. While today's results were good, valuation at c.1.1x P/TBV 26e for c.13% ROTE (lowered to c.11-12% including restructuring) does not look cheap. Reiterate Underperform.

3Q25 summary – c.10% pre-provision beat

Underlying PBT was 14% (or \$243m) ahead of consensus, reflecting a 3% (or \$166m) beat in income, a 1% (or \$27m) beat in cost, and credit impairment which was 23% (or \$57m) better. Beat was c.10% at the pre-provision level. Within income, NII was 2% (or \$65m) ahead and non-NII was 4% (or \$101m) ahead. The beat in non-NII was driven by higher Banking and Wealth, partially offset by lower Global Markets given lower episodic income as previously communicated. CET1 of 14.2% was slightly ahead of consensus 14.1%, reflecting higher profits.

Guidance – upgraded 2025 guidance on income and ROTE

Management upgraded two key pieces of guidance, including (i) income growth to be towards upper end of 5-7% range (previously guided around bottom of range) at constant currency (ccy), ex notable items. Implied total income of c.\$20.7bn (consensus c.\$20.6bn); and expect to deliver an underlying RoTE of c.13% in 2025 (consensus c.13.1%). Management also confirmed that updated 2026 ROTE will be provided at FY25 results, and medium-term financial expectations will be provided in May 2026.

30 October 2025

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Stock Data

Price	153.00 HKD
Price Objective	139.10 HKD
Date Established	16-Oct-2025
Investment Opinion	B-3-7
52-Week Range	86.25 HKD-158.50 HKD
Mrkt Val / Shares Out (mn)	45,130 USD / 2,292.1
Market Value (mn)	350,688 HKD
Average Daily Value (mn)	14.78 USD
Free Float	100.0%
BofA Ticker / Exchange	XCHBF / HKG
Bloomberg / Reuters	2888 HK / 2888.HK
ROE (2025E)	9.6%

CET1: Core Equity Tier 1

NII: Net Interest Income

PBT: Profit Before Tax

RWA: Risk Weighted Asset

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3Q25 summary

Exhibit 1: 3Q25 actual versus consensus

Underlying PBT beat of 14% driven by higher income and lower impairments

	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25			3Q25 vs		
	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Cons	BofA	Cons	2Q24	2Q25
Profit & loss												
Net interest income	2,656	2,694	2,769	2,977	2,796	2,703	2,737	2,672	2,692	2%	-1%	1%
Non interest income	2,496	2,112	2,135	1,857	2,594	2,806	2,410	2,309	2,277	4%	13%	-14%
Operating income	5,152	4,806	4,904	4,834	5,390	5,509	5,147	4,981	4,969	3%	5%	-7%
Operating expenses	(2,786)	(2,887)	(2,840)	(3,277)	(2,915)	(3,050)	(2,953)	(2,980)	(3,023)	-1%	4%	-3%
Credit impairment	(176)	(73)	(178)	(130)	(219)	(117)	(195)	(252)	(252)	-23%	10%	67%
Other impairment	(60)	(83)	(92)	(353)	(6)	(3)	(20)	(19)	(33)	5%	-78%	567%
Associates & JVs	(1)	65	13	(27)	27	64	6	11	18	-45%	-54%	-91%
Underlying profit before tax	2,129	1,828	1,807	1,047	2,277	2,403	1,985	1,741	1,679	14%	10%	-17%
Restructuring charges	(55)	(95)	(91)	(200)	(170)	(123)	(219)	(221)	(260)	-	-	-
DVA	(48)	22	5	(3)					0	-	-	-
Other	(112)	(177)	1	(44)	(4)				0	-	-	-
Statutory profit before tax	1,914	1,578	1,722	800	2,103	2,280	1,766	1,520	1,419	16%	3%	-23%
Key metrics												
Underlying ROTE	15.2%	12.9%	10.8%	8.1%	16.4%	19.7%	13.40%	10.1%	10.2%	3.30%	2.60%	-6.30%
CET1 ratio	13.6%	14.6%	14.2%	14.2%	13.8%	14.3%	14.2%	14.1%	14.0%	0.1%	0.00%	-0.10%
RWA (\$bn)	252,116	241,926	248,900	247,065	253,596	259,700	258,400	259,400	259,499	0%	4%	-1%
Net customer loans	283,403	275,896	287,300	281,032	281,788	286,700	285,100	287,900	286,731	-1%	-1%	-1%
Loan loss rate	0.25%	0.11%	0.21%	0.19%	0.25%	0.12%	0.24%	0.35%	0.35%	-0.11%	0.03%	0.12%
TNAVPS	13.90	14.44	15.09	15.41	15.62	16.80	16.84	16.85	16.84	0%	12%	0%
Dividend	0.00	9.00		28.00		12.30		0.00	0.00			
Buybacks	0	1,500		1,500		1,300		0	0			

Source: Company consensus, BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Price objective basis & risk

Standard Chartered (XCHBF)

Our valuation methodology is a Gordon Growth Model based on our 2027E forecasts, to which we add the present value of expected dividends. With a 12.5% cost of equity assumption, this suggests a price to book multiple of 1.0x, reducing to 0.8x when discounted to a year from now at our cost of equity. We apply this to 2026E tangible book value and add the dividends we forecast through to 2027E (also discounted), and adjust for excess capital to the bottom end of management guidance. Using this valuation approach, we arrive at a price objective of HKD139.10.

Upside risks to our PO are 1) US rates stay higher for longer, terminal rate higher than expected, 2) further stimulus from the Chinese government, 3) Emerging Asia/ Hong Kong loan growth recovers faster than expected.

Downside risks to our PO are 1) loan growth remains subdued for longer, 2) Wealth Management flows slow as competition intensifies, 3) global trade flows reduce more than expected with higher tariffs.



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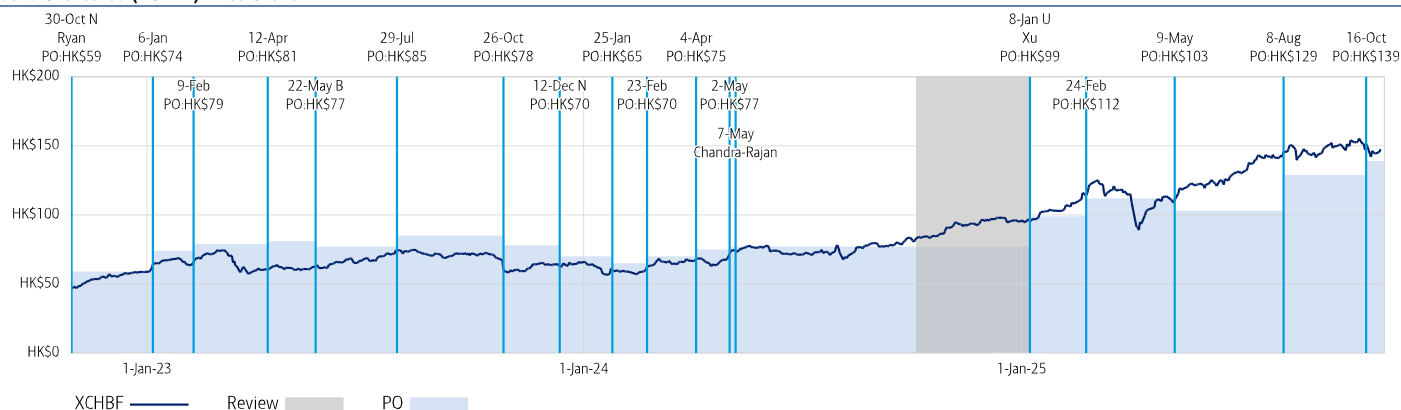
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Standard Chartered (XCHBF) Price Chart



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Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	112	53.33%	Buy	91	81.25%
Hold	50	23.81%	Hold	39	78.00%
Sell	48	22.86%	Sell	39	81.25%

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Buy	1816	53.11%	Buy	1062	58.48%
Hold	825	24.13%	Hold	480	58.18%
Sell	778	22.76%	Sell	385	49.49%

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Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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